Valentine Rutto

+254728057123

valentinrutto@gmail.com

https://github.com/valentinerutto

https://www.linkedin.com/in/valentinerutto/

https://valentinerutto.github.io

Professional Summary

Senior Mobile Developer with 8+ years of experience building and owning production-grade mobile applications across fintech, PAYGO, warehouse, and field operations, used across 35+ African markets. Strong expertise in Kotlin, Java, KMP, Flutter, Jetpack Compose, Clean Architecture, MVVM/MVI, offline-first systems, API integration, CI/CD, and performance optimization. Experienced in end-to-end delivery, production monitoring, mentoring, and cross-functional collaboration. Hands-on experience integrating AI-powered capabilities and exploring on-device inference, with a strong focus on product quality, maintainability, and user experience.

Core Skills

Android [Java, Kotlin], KMP, Flutter, Android SDK,
Jetpack Compose & XML, Gradle, Bazel, SOLID Principles &Design Patterns, Clean & AI Architecture, Modularized & AI-Powered Apps,
Git, CI/CD, Firebase, Unit Testing, REST API, GraphQL, AI APIs.

Work Experience

Burn Manufacturing

April 2025 - January 2026

Senior Mobile Applications Developer

April 2025-Present

- Owned and led end-to-end development and continuous improvement of the native Android platform, delivering critical features for field agents across 6+ African countries and supporting reliable retail operations across diverse markets.
- Managed the full feature and release lifecycle, from requirements gathering and technical design to implementation, testing, release management, and application distribution. Collaborated with product managers to assess technical feasibility, identify implementation constraints, and translate business requirements into actionable engineering specifications.
- Refactored legacy code to align with SOLID principles and modern Android architecture, improving code maintainability, modularity, and architectural consistency while simplifying future feature development.
- Resolved thread-management issues by ensuring operations executed on the appropriate threads, eliminating identified crashes and Application Not Responding (ANR) incidents associated with these issues and improving application stability.

- Architected robust database migration strategies and thread-management optimizations, eliminating ANR incidents and ensuring seamless offline-first data synchronization across application versions.
- Enhanced customer registration and Eco Cooker sales workflows by improving UI and data flows, implementing local data persistence, and leveraging lifecycle-aware Android components to improve usability and operational reliability for field agents.
- Improved forward and backward navigation flows, delivering more intuitive screen transitions and a consistent user experience throughout key agent workflows.
- Mentored junior Android developers through technical guidance, code reviews, and knowledge sharing, strengthening engineering practices, code quality, and adherence to architectural standards.

Play Store Link: Buisy

Twiga Foods

Senior Android Engineer

June 2024 - June 2025

- **Led Android engineering** across two business-critical applications: a field agent application and a modularized Warehouse Data Management System (DMS), supporting sales, inventory, warehouse, and logistics operations across multiple markets.
- **Owned Android technical architecture and development direction**, designing and delivering modular features aligned with business requirements, product strategy, and user experience standards. Modernized legacy Java codebases by migrating to Kotlin and adopting modern Android libraries and architectural patterns, improving maintainability, application stability, and developer productivity.
- **Designed and implemented** the **Scan-to-Truck feature**, introducing barcode-based inventory scanning and three-way matching to reconcile products against truck dispatch and delivery records. Improved inventory accuracy and product traceability, reduced discrepancies and product losses, and enabled better visibility into product movement throughout distribution workflows.
- **Enhanced warehouse returns management** by streamlining barcode scanning and return-processing workflows, enabling warehouse staff to identify, record, and reconcile returned products more efficiently. Improved inventory visibility and supported timely processing of returned stock.
- **Architected and implemented offline-first** inventory scanning and data synchronization capabilities, allowing field agents and warehouse personnel to continue operations in low-connectivity environments. Leveraged Android WorkManager to synchronize locally stored transactions when network connectivity became reliably available.

- **Partnered with product managers**, **backend engineers**, and operations stakeholders to translate business requirements into technical specifications, assess implementation feasibility, design scalable solutions, and ensure seamless integration between mobile applications and backend systems.
- **Owned the end-to-end** feature delivery and release lifecycle, from technical implementation and stakeholder-led MVP validation to QA coordination, production deployment, and Google Play Store releases. Monitored live applications, investigated and reproduced production issues, identified root causes, and delivered timely fixes to maintain application reliability and minimize operational disruption.
- **Mentored junior Android engineers** through technical guidance, code reviews, and knowledge sharing, promoting clean code practices, architectural consistency, and engineering quality across the team.

Play Store Link: Twiga DMS

Play Store Link: Twiga Agent

LD Talent Network

Android Engineer | part-time

November 2023-Present

- I create comprehensive technical documentation and user guides for Android applications, ensuring clear and accurate instructions for developers and end-users.
- I collaborate closely with the development team to understand complex technical concepts and translate them into user-friendly language.
- I also work as a consultant for LD clients, collaborating with their team to build innovative and exciting Android applications.

D.Light

Android Engineer

June 2020 - october 2022

- Led the development and continuous improvement of two native Android applications using Kotlin and modern Android architecture:
  - Atlas: An internal, modularized application consolidating seven business applications into a single platform, supporting employees across 35+ markets where d.light operates.
  - PayGo: A customer-facing application enabling customers to manage their Pay-As-You-Go (PAYGo) products, monitor account information, and make payments conveniently.
- Designed and implemented application architecture using Clean Architecture and MVVM, improving code organization, maintainability, modularity, and scalability across both applications.

- Integrated RESTful APIs and implemented robust networking and error-handling mechanisms to ensure reliable application functionality in environments with unstable or intermittent connectivity.

- Developed offline-first capabilities using Room for local data persistence, enabling users to access and manage critical information with limited or no internet connectivity, particularly in underserved markets.

- Optimized application performance by reducing startup time, improving background processing, and restructuring networking operations using WorkManager for reliable asynchronous execution and data synchronization.

- Implemented data synchronization improvements and resolved application stability issues, contributing to an 80% reduction in crashes and a 40% improvement in user retention.

- Collaborated with backend engineers, QA specialists, and product teams throughout the software development lifecycle, translating product requirements into technical solutions and delivering features from implementation through testing and release.

- Integrated Firebase services, including Crashlytics, Analytics, and Cloud Messaging (FCM), to support production monitoring, crash analysis, user engagement tracking, and push notifications.

Play Store Link : https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.dlight.paygo

Play Store Link : https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.dlight.atlas

KOKO Networks

Android Engineer

March 2019 - June 2020

- Developed a media-focused Android application for KOKO Labs, integrating media APIs and third-party SDKs to enable music and video downloads during cooking fuel refill journeys, contributing to a 20% improvement in user retention.
- Contributed to the development and maintenance of the core KOKO Fuel Android application, implementing features across the cooker purchase journey, from translating UI designs into functional interfaces to integrating backend APIs and supporting end-to-end user workflows.
- Modernized the KOKO Fuel Android application by migrating legacy Java code to Kotlin and transitioning from MVP to MVVM architecture, improving code maintainability, application performance, and stability while contributing to an 80% reduction in crash rates.
- Refactored callback-heavy asynchronous operations using Kotlin Coroutines, improving concurrency management, error handling, code readability, and lifecycle awareness.
- Collaborated with product managers and designers to review requirements, evaluate UI designs, and implement intuitive user interfaces aligned with product and business objectives.
- Improved application quality and test automation by writing unit tests using JUnit and MockK, validating business logic and increasing confidence in application changes and releases.
- Contributed to CI/CD integration and release processes, supporting automated build and testing workflows to improve release readiness and development efficiency.

- Supported production release management and post-release maintenance by investigating issues reported by the Network Operations Centre (NOC), reproducing bugs, identifying root causes, resolving Android-related issues, and coordinating with relevant backend and engineering teams to ensure timely fixes and maintain application stability.

PlayStoreLink: :
https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.kokonetworks.mykoko,
https://kokofuel.com/

Kountable

Associate Android Engineer

October 2018 - December 2018

- Contributed to the development and maintenance of a customer-facing native Android application facilitating trade transactions between SMEs, international suppliers, and payment partners, working collaboratively with senior engineers.
- Implemented application features based on product requirements and UI/UX designs, translating business workflows into functional Android interfaces while adhering to established coding standards and architectural practices.
- Integrated third-party SDKs, libraries, and RESTful APIs to support core application functionality, data exchange, and external service integrations.
- Developed practical expertise in Android lifecycle management, multithreading, UI development, and application architecture while contributing to debugging, testing, and defect resolution.
- Collaborated with senior engineers and cross-functional team members during feature development, code reviews, testing, and troubleshooting, building a strong foundation in software engineering practices and collaborative product delivery.

Education

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science / Degree
Dedan Kimathi University of Science and Technology

Software Development / Certificate
Moringa School.

Community

Android Blog / Blogger
This is my blog, where I write about Android Development and development tips

Android254 / Member and Speaker
I am an active member of the Android254 community in Kenya; I mostly participate in the capacity of a speaker.

Google WomenTechmakers / Member and Speaker

I am an active member of several WTM chapters, where I give technical talks on Android, host/attend panel sessions, and mentor tech beginners.

Andela Learning Community (ALC) Meetup Facilitator / Mentor
I volunteer as an ALC Facilitator and Mentor for the Android track by organizing meetups and mentoring learners on Android development best practices.

Google for Startups Technical Mentor

Featured By

Google Android Dev Blog 🔥
My Android developer journey and experience were featured in the Google Android Developers journey spotlight Blog with 4 other developers from around the world. It can also be found on social media under #AndroidDevJourney.

link: Androiddevjourney-spotlight

ProAndroidDev Technical Blog : Seamless Camera and Media Access on Android 14+ and Legacy Versions

Kotlin Weekly and Android Weekly Newsletters